

THE POTATO PEOPLE



One Friday when the clouds were big and black and the rain dribbled down the window panes and rattled on the tin roof, there was a knock at the door.

‘Jack!’ gasped Grandma, and they hugged and hugged.

They played hide and seek.

They romped roly-poly on the ground.

They read stories. And they ate cake.

‘Grandma?’ asked Jack. ‘What happened to our little potato people?’

‘I buried them outside in the compost heap,’ said Grandma, ‘and they grew and grew.’

‘Let’s go and look,’ said Jack.

So they put on their raincoats, pulled on their gumboots, and went out in the rain to see. But all they could see were the stalks, now brown and dead, lying on top of the ground.

So Grandma fetched a big fork and Jack fetched a little fork and they dug and they dug and they dug.



First Grandma found one potato, then Jack found two potatoes. They found big potatoes and they found little potatoes. Soon there were hundreds and hundreds of potatoes.

When there were no more potatoes left to dig, they hung up their forks, they took off their raincoats, they put away their gumboots and they washed their hands.

‘Grandma?’ said Jack.

‘Yes?’ said Grandma.

‘Let’s make a little potato man and a little potato woman.’

And they did.

1. How can the reader tell that Grandma was pleased to see Jack?
 - (A) She hugged him.
 - (B) She opened the door.
 - (C) She gave him some potatoes.
 - (D) She showed him the compost heap.
2. Grandma buried the potato people in the compost heap because
 - (A) they were too raw to eat.
 - (B) she wanted them to grow.
 - (C) she was hiding them from Jack.
 - (D) Jack wanted to keep them out of the rain.
3. Grandma and Jack went outside because they wanted to
 - (A) eat some cake.
 - (B) look for potatoes.
 - (C) play hide and seek.
 - (D) romp on the ground.
4. When Grandma and Jack looked at the compost heap, they saw
 - (A) some dead stalks.
 - (B) their old raincoats.
 - (C) some gardening forks.
 - (D) two pairs of gumboots.
5. What did Jack want to do when he went back into the house?
 - (A) make a cake
 - (B) play in the rain
 - (C) make potato people
 - (D) cook some potatoes



TARANTULA

As big as a dinner plate and with eight eyes and eight bristly legs, the tarantula looks fearsome. But how scary is it?

There are many different kinds of tarantula, from different parts of the world. For most people, though, 'tarantula' means one of the large, hairy spiders that come from North, Central and South America. The best-known of these spiders is the Mexican red-kneed tarantula.

Big and hairy

Tarantulas are big. The bodies of North American tarantulas can be longer than an adult's middle finger, and their leg span is as wide as an adult's hand. Their South American cousins are even bigger.

Long-lived

Some tarantulas live for only a few months, others for up to 18 months, but tarantulas

can live for as long as 25 years or more. In Mexico, one female tarantula lived for nearly 30 years.

Lying in wait

Tarantulas live in burrows underground, which they dig with their fangs. They line the insides with ribbons of a special substance called spider's silk. Unlike common garden spiders, they don't make webs to catch prey. Instead, they wait to pounce when a likely-looking snack comes along. In the heat of the day, tarantulas rest. They hunt at night for insects, such as beetles. They also enjoy special treats of small frogs, toads, mice or small birds.

Shy spiders

Although they look fierce, tarantulas are in fact shy creatures which stay in their burrows most of the time. Some can be kept as pets.

Mexican red-kneed tarantula

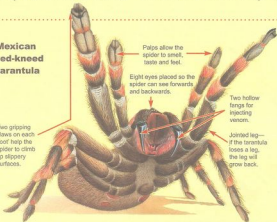
Two gripping claws on each foot help the spider to climb up slippery surfaces.

Palps allow the spider to smell, taste and feel.

Eight eyes placed so the spider can see forwards and backwards.

Two hollow fangs for injecting venom.

Jointed leg—if the tarantula loses a leg, the leg will grow back.



6. In the text the size of the tarantula is compared to
- (A) a small frog.
 - (B) a small bird.
 - (C) a dinner plate.
 - (D) a garden spider.
7. The tarantula spins spider's silk in order to
- (A) build its large web.
 - (B) trap mice and insects.
 - (C) make itself appear fierce.
 - (D) make a lining for its burrow.
8. What do tarantulas usually do in the evenings?
- (A) hunt
 - (B) sleep
 - (C) build burrows
 - (D) hide from toads
9. How many eyes does a tarantula have?
- (A) 2
 - (B) 8
 - (C) 18
 - (D) 25
10. The Mexican red-kneed tarantula uses its claws to
- (A) spin its silk.
 - (B) catch its prey.
 - (C) stop it from slipping as it climbs.
 - (D) dig burrows beneath the ground.
11. Which part of the tarantula injects poison into its prey?
- (A) the legs
 - (B) the feet
 - (C) the palps
 - (D) the fangs
12. The purpose of this text is to
- (A) warn people about tarantulas.
 - (B) describe some features of tarantulas.
 - (C) explain the life cycle of red-kneed tarantulas.
 - (D) give advice about keeping tarantulas as pets.

Let's Get A Pup!

'Let's get a pup!' said Kate.

'What, a brand-new one?' said a now wide-awake Mum.

'With the wrapping still on?' added her breathless dad.

'Pups don't come wrapped,' replied Kate.

'I know they don't,' said Dad. 'It's just a joke.'

Mum looked in the paper.

'It must be small,' said Kate.

'And cute,' said Dad.

'And get all excited,' said Kate.

'And run round in circles,' said Dad.

'Hmm,' said Mum. 'LOOK!'



THE RESCUE CENTRE

The centre for dogs without a home

The centre for dogs all alone

With their breakfast uneaten, they dressed and left immediately.

At the Rescue Centre they found plenty of dogs without a home, and lots of dogs all alone. They found ... big dogs, small dogs, sniffers and sleepers, wire-haired, short-haired, scratchers and leapers.

They found fighters and biters, growlers and snarlers, short dogs, dogs long and thin, and dogs with their cheeks sucked in.

Then they saw ... Dave.

Dave was so excited he came out sideways. He barked twice, water flew off his tongue and he turned a complete circle in the air. He was small. He was cute. He was brand-new. Dave climbed right over the top of Kate, who briefly wore him like a hat.

'He's all that we want,' said Kate.

'All that we came for,' said Mum.

'We'll take him,' said Dad.



13. Mum says 'Hmm' because she
- (A) cannot hear what Dad is saying.
 - (B) wants a different kind of pet.
 - (C) is thinking about getting a dog.
 - (D) does not want to go to the Rescue Centre.



14. **THE RESCUE CENTRE**
The centre for dogs without a home
The centre for dogs all alone

Why have these words been written in a different type from the rest of the story?

- (A) because they are spoken by Kate
 - (B) because they are Mum's thoughts
 - (C) to show where the Rescue Centre is
 - (D) to show that they are from the newspaper
15. The word 'immediately' tells the reader that the family left the house
- (A) at once.
 - (B) in a hurry.
 - (C) without talking.
 - (D) without thinking.



16. Which of the following statements is TRUE?
- (A) When the family first saw Dave, he was having a drink of water.
 - (B) When the family first saw Dave, he was growling at the other dogs.
 - (C) When the family first saw Dave, he was full of energy.
 - (D) When the family first saw Dave, he was unfriendly.



17. A verb is an action word. Which of the underlined words in the following sentence is a verb?
He barked twice, water flew off his tongue and he turned a complete circle in the air.
- (A) (B) (C) (D)

18. Which of the following lines from the story makes it clear that the family has decided to keep Dave?
- (A) 'LOOK!'
 - (B) Then they saw ... Dave.
 - (C) He was brand-new.
 - (D) 'We'll take him'

Winnie the Pooh

Winnie the Pooh is a favourite character with children all over the world. He is a lovable but not very smart bear and the imaginary adventures of Winnie and his friends have delighted children for over 70 years. But the magic of Winnie started long before that.

The history of Winnie the Pooh began when a young Canadian soldier named Harry Coleburn, who was also a vet, was on his way to fight in World War I. When the train in which he was travelling stopped at White River Bend station, Harry saw a man carrying a young black bear cub. Harry discovered that the man was a hunter who had shot and killed the cub's mother. He bought the young cub and named her Winnipeg after his home town. Soon he shortened this to Winnie.



Harry took the young bear to London with him where it became the mascot for the soldiers of his brigade. In 1919 the brigade was sent to France. Harry knew he could not take Winnie with him so he donated her to London Zoo.

Winnie quickly became the zoo's most popular attraction. One young fan was a little boy named Christopher Robin Milne. Christopher liked Winnie so much that he renamed his teddy bear after her. He added 'the Pooh' from the name of a swan in one of his father's poems—so his teddy bear became known as 'Winnie the Pooh'.

Christopher's father, A.A. Milne, was a writer. He had written a book of poems for young children titled *When We Were Very Young*. In 1925 he wrote a bedtime story for his son. It featured a small boy named Christopher Robin, a teddy bear named Winnie the Pooh and a number of other toy animals, based on Christopher's own stuffed toys. The adventures of Winnie the Pooh, Tigger, Eeyore, Piglet and their friends were set in a magical place called the Hundred Acre Wood which was in fact Cotchford Farm, where the Milne family lived. In 1926 A.A. Milne included this story as the first chapter of the book *Winnie-the-Pooh*.

While the real bear that inspired the stories died in 1934, the adventures of Winnie the Pooh continue to delight children through stories and films.

19. Harry Coleburn was a soldier and
- (A) a vet.
 - (B) a writer.
 - (C) a hunter.
 - (D) a farmer.
20. In what year was Winnie donated to London Zoo?
- (A) 1919
 - (B) 1925
 - (C) 1926
 - (D) 1934
21. What was the origin of 'Pooh' in the name 'Winnie the Pooh'?
- (A) It was made up to rhyme with 'zoo'.
 - (B) It was the pet name given to Christopher Robin.
 - (C) It was a name taken from a particular breed of bear.
 - (D) It was the name of a swan in one of A.A. Milne's poems.
22. In the text the letters 'A.A.' are
- (A) an abbreviation of a poem's title.
 - (B) the first letters of a person's given names.
 - (C) a title given to authors of children's books.
 - (D) a special name Christopher had for his father.
23. The book *Winnie-the-Pooh* was developed from
- (A) everyday events on Colchford Farm.
 - (B) Winnie's experiences at London Zoo.
 - (C) a bedtime story for Christopher Robin.
 - (D) a poem in *When We Were Very Young*.
24. The idea for the characters of Eeyore and Tigger came from
- (A) some animals at the zoo.
 - (B) some of Christopher Robin's toys.
 - (C) some of the animals that lived on the farm.
 - (D) some wild animals in the Hundred Acre Wood.

The Lionfish

Many remarkable creatures live in coral reefs. The lionfish is (25) particularly beautiful. It has colourful stripes on its body and sharp spines on its back.

By day, the lionfish (26) shelters in holes on the bottom of the reef but at night it hunts for food. While looking for small fish and shrimp, the lionfish swims slowly. However, when it spies its (27) unfortunate prey, it (28) streaks through the water like lightning.

25. (A) especially
(B) probably
(C) normally
(D) completely

26. (A) plays
(B) hides
(C) sinks
(D) leaves

27. (A) impossible
(B) unlucky
(C) unusual
(D) important

28. (A) steers
(B) turns
(C) speeds
(D) attacks



For questions 29 to 31 choose the correct option.

29. My cousins are coming to visit. They're good football players so we will have fun.
The word 'They're' can be replaced by
- (A) Their
 - (B) There
 - (C) They are
 - (D) They were
30. Choose the correct option to complete the sentence.
Our family _____ to Bella Vista Beach for the holidays since I was four years old.
- (A) goes
 - (B) went
 - (C) is gone
 - (D) has been going
31. Choose the option which combines these two sentences correctly.
I enjoy reading. I visit the library every week to borrow new books.
- (A) I enjoy reading so that I visit the library every week to borrow new books.
 - (B) I visit the library every week to borrow new books because I enjoy reading.
 - (C) Although I enjoy reading, I visit the library every week to borrow new books.
 - (D) Whenever I visit the library every week to borrow new books, I enjoy reading.
-

For questions 32 and 33 choose the sentence which is PUNCTUATED CORRECTLY.

32. (A) The childrens book's section in the bookshop has many activities.
(B) The children's books section in the bookshop has many activities.
(C) The children's book's section in the bookshop has many activities.
(D) The childrens' books' section in the bookshop has many activities.
33. (A) Do you think the train will arrive on time?
(B) Tell me when you think the train is coming?
(C) Dad asked Mum what time the train would arrive?
(D) The passengers began asking which train was coming?

ARLY and JAI

At the very front of the classroom sat a boy called Jai.

At the very back of the classroom sat a girl called Arly.

Jai was the best handball player in the class. He liked to sit at the front so he could be first out the door at lunchtime to secure the best handball court.

Arly liked to sit at the back so she could daydream or read comics under the desk when no-one was looking. She also liked to illustrate her own comic stories. However, just across the aisle was Cassie, the biggest tell-tale in the class.

'Mr Mack,' Cassie would whine, 'Arly isn't doing her maths. She's drawing again.'

After another of Cassie's complaints, Mr Mack announced, 'Today I'm going to make some changes. Jai, Arly, I think you should swap seats.'

'But, Mr Mack,' protested Jai quickly, 'I won't be able to see the blackboard!'

Arly didn't say anything but she quickly hid the comic book down the front of her sweater. It made the front of her body look square, like a robot.

'No excuses,' said Mr Mack sternly. 'Hurry up!'

Arly and Jai changed seats reluctantly. Arly felt uncomfortable being so close to the teacher and the comic was scratching her but she didn't dare remove it. It rustled as she moved. Jai was worried. When the bell rang, the other children would beat him to his handball court.

Mr Mack was writing spelling words on the board. The children started to copy the words down in their books—even Arly.

Suddenly, there was a strange rumbling sound. Everyone dropped their pencils, stood up and looked out the window. A large green dinosaur had roamed into the playground. It tipped over some garbage bins, gave a huge roar and then stomped across the soccer field, off into the distance.

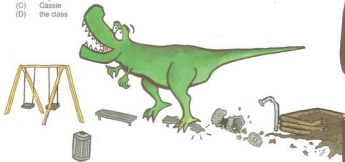
'Phew!' said Mr Mack, wiping his brow. 'That was close!' He coughed and tugged on his beard. 'Now everyone, settle down and get back to work.'

He did not notice that Jai and Arly had swapped seats again. He was probably still a bit upset about the dinosaur.

Jai sat back and relaxed. Arly pulled out her comic.

She heard a familiar voice beside her calling, 'Mr Mack ...'

34. Jai wanted to sit at the front of the class so that he could
- (A) be close to his teacher.
 - (B) see the blackboard clearly.
 - (C) avoid sitting near Arly and Cassie.
 - (D) leave the room quickly at break times.
35. What did Arly like to do at school?
- (A) do maths
 - (B) tell stories
 - (C) draw pictures
 - (D) talk to Cassie
36. Cassie could best be described as
- (A) a girl who enjoys making trouble for others.
 - (B) an active girl who spends time playing sport.
 - (C) a studious person who listens carefully in class.
 - (D) a friendly person who tries to help her classmates.
37. In the text the word '**his**' has been placed in bold font. Why has the writer done this?
- (A) to show the court is only for boys
 - (B) to emphasise Jai's skill as a handball player
 - (C) to provide a contrast with the rest of the sentence
 - (D) to indicate that Jai feels he is in charge of the court
38. How did Mr Mack feel when he saw the dinosaur in the playground?
- (A) He was worried that it might hurt itself.
 - (B) He was angry because it had disturbed the children.
 - (C) He was amused because it was large and brightly coloured.
 - (D) He was concerned that it might try to come into the classroom.
39. In the last sentence who says 'Mr Mack ...'?
- (A) Jai
 - (B) Arly
 - (C) Cassie
 - (D) the class



Seahorses

Inside the large aquarium,
Within a tank, behind the glass,
Seahorses swim.

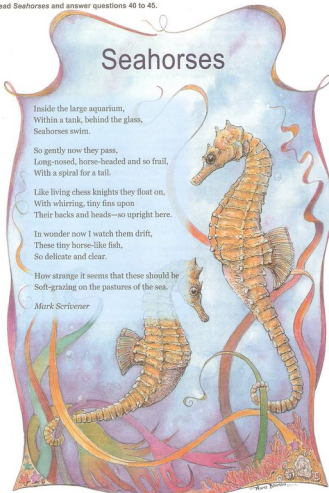
So gently now they pass,
Long-nosed, horse-headed and so frail,
With a spiral for a tail.

Like living chess knights they float on,
With whirring, tiny fins upon
Their backs and heads—so upright here.

In wonder now I watch them drift,
These tiny horse-like fish,
So delicate and clear.

How strange it seems that these should be
Soft-grazing on the pastures of the sea.

Mark Scrivener



40. Which of the following describes the seahorses' movement?
- (A) They use their tails to rotate slowly in the water.
 - (B) They use their noses to guide them around the tank.
 - (C) They shake their heads as they dart around the tank.
 - (D) They keep their bodies vertical as they glide in the water.
41. A simile compares one thing with another. Which of the following is a simile?
- (A) 'Seahorses swim'
 - (B) 'Long-nosed, horse-headed'
 - (C) 'With a spiral for a tail'
 - (D) 'Like living chess knights they float on'
42. Which other word in the poem has the same meaning as 'trail'?
- (A) 'tiny'
 - (B) 'delicate'
 - (C) 'strange'
 - (D) 'soft'
43. How does the poet feel as he watches the seahorses?
- (A) amazed
 - (B) amused
 - (C) comforted
 - (D) encouraged
44. In the last line the poet describes the bottom of the aquarium as the 'pastures'. He does this in order to
- (A) contrast the difference between the tank and a field.
 - (B) emphasise the similarity between horses and seahorses.
 - (C) draw attention to the feelings of the seahorses in the tank.
 - (D) illustrate how the seahorses have adapted to their environment.
45. Which of the following pairs of words are rhymes?
- (A) 'aquarium' and 'glass'
 - (B) 'swim' and 'pass'
 - (C) 'here' and 'clear'
 - (D) 'drift' and 'fish'





UNSW
THE UNIVERSITY OF NEW SOUTH WALES

**EDUCATIONAL ASSESSMENT
AUSTRALIA**

2007 Answer Keys

International Competitions & Assessments for Schools

English

Question Number	Paper A	Paper B	Paper C	Paper D	Paper E	Paper F	Papers G & H	Papers I & J
1	A	A	C	C	B	C	D	B
2	B	A	A	A	A	A	C	C
3	B	D	A	D	A	A	C	A
4	A	B	B	B	B	D	A	A
5	C	C	A	C	D	D	B	D
6	C	B	D	B	D	B	D	C
7	D	D	C	D	B	A	B	C
8	A	C	D	B	B	A	D	D
9	B	A	B	A	A	D	C	A
10	C	B	C	A	C	C	D	D
11	D	A	A	C	A	C	B	D
12	B	C	A	C	C	B	A	B
13	C	D	B	A	A	C	D	D
14	D	C	D	D	A	B	C	C
15	A	B	D	D	B	B	D	D
16	C	A	A	A	D	A	C	A
17	C	A	B	B	B	D	D	B
18	D	D	C	B	D	B	A	D
19	A	C	D	C	D	C	B	C
20	A	C	C	C	C	D	C	B
21	D	A	B	D	D	D	D	D
22	B	D	B	C	A	A	B	B
23	C	A	C	B	A	D	A	C
24	B	A	C	A	A	B	C	C
25	A	C	D	A	B	B	D	D
26	B	D	C	B	D	C	A	B
27	B	C	D	D	C	D	A	B
28	C	B	A	C	D	B	A	A
29	C	A	D	D	D	D	B	B
30	D	D	B	A	A	B	B	D
31	B	C	D	B	D	C	A	A
32	B	B	A	D	B	B	C	C
33	A	A	B	B	B	A	C	C
34	D	D	B	D	A	C	B	C
35	C	A	C	D	B	C	C	D
36	A	B	B	C	C	C	A	A
37	D	C	A	C	C	D	A	A
38	D	D	C	D	A	D	B	D
39	C	C	A	A	C	D	D	D
40	D	D	C	C	C	C	A	B

(Please turn over)

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Question Number	Paper A	Paper B	Paper C	Paper D	Paper E	Paper F	Papers G & H	Papers I & J
41	D	C	C	D	D	B	C	C
42	B	B	D	B	B	C	B	A
43	A	D	D	A	D	A	C	A
44	B	B	A	A	B	C	D	B
45	C	B	A	C	A	D	A	D
46			B	D	C	A	A	A
47			C	D	B	A	B	C
48			B	A	B	A	C	D
49			D	A	C	C	C	A
50			A	B	D	D	D	A
51					C	C	B	C
52					C	B	B	B
53					A	B	C	D
54					C	A	C	A
55					A	A	B	B
56							A	D
57							D	B
58							D	C
59							A	A
60							C	B

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